and the recipients of messages. A free flow of communication, through facilitating transmission of understanding paves the way for the development of good human relations in the organisation.

7.18 Types of Communication

Organisational communication may be either formal or informal in nature.

1. Formal communications

Formal communications are those which flow through formally established channels as depicted in the formal organisational chart, and are concerned with work related matters. All orders, instructions and decisions are communicated to the subordinates through this channel. Formal communications can flow in three different directions – downward, upward, and horizontal or laterally among various departments.



Figure 7.8 Formal Communication

2. Downward communications

Downward communications are those communications that flow from superiors to subordinates. Through downward communication, the superior direct the efforts of his subordinates, defines the goals, and objectives of the organisation to them.

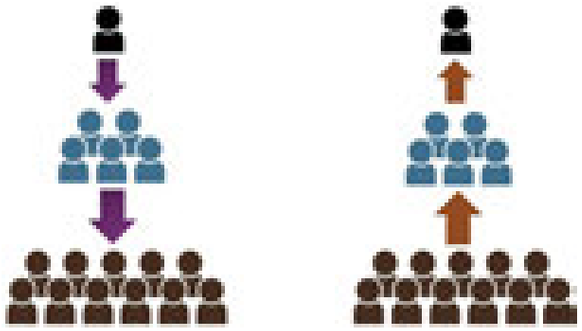


Figure 7.9 Downward and Upward Communication

3. Upward communications

Flow from the subordinates to the superiors, and are usually known as feedback. These enables the management to assess how far the downward communication has reached, understood, accepted, and carried out. These can help the management to know the employee grievances and receive valuable suggestions from the people at lower levels.

4. Horizontal or lateral communications

Refers to the communications across the subordinates who are working at the same level in the organisation. Such communications help coordinate the activities of different departments.



Figure 7.10 Horizontal Communication

5. Informal communication

Informal communication or the 'grapevine' as it is commonly known

XII OSS_English version CHAPTER 07.indd 92 1/7/2020 6:03:14 PM